

Chemical messengers

In addition to the nervous system, the body has a second control system—the endocrine system. This releases hormones into the bloodstream.

Hormones are chemical messengers that target specific body tissues and change the way they act. They control growth, reproduction, and many other processes.

Making hormones

This body map shows some of the endocrine glands that release hormones and make up the endocrine system. Some, such as the pituitary, thyroid, and adrenal glands, only release hormones. Some also have other functions—for example, the kidneys also filter the blood and make urine.

The **adrenal gland** releases epinephrine, which prepares the body to deal with danger

The **pancreas** releases two hormones that control blood sugar levels

The **pituitary gland** releases nine hormones

The **thyroid gland** releases two hormones

Kidneys release renin, which helps control blood pressure

